

Since the Textus Receptus was overcome by the scholarly textual criticism of the 19th century, there is tenacious negative bias against the Byzantine majority text. Wherever well-known, older textual witnesses like Vaticanus and Sinaiticus, and even more so in combination with a papyrus, stand against the majority of minuscules, the decision against the majority text was often made easily, without seriously considering the quality of the variants in question. Therefore, the editors of the present edition have taken two factors as paramount.

First, it is often overlooked that in the vast majority of variant passages only a few witnesses differ from all the others. As a rule, the popular witnesses from the 4th / 5th centuries and, if extant, from even earlier papyri, agree with the majority of all witnesses. This implies that at all these passages the old age of the majority text is not in doubt.

Second, it is necessary to distinguish consistently between a manuscript and the text transmitted in it. “*Recentiores non deteriores*” is a principle widely accepted in editing philology, but in New Testament scholarship it was applied only to a few younger manuscripts featuring similar textual peculiarities as Vaticanus and Sinaiticus. For the reason given above, it is undoubtedly true that the textual tradition as a whole goes back to a very early period and that the coherent transmission of the majority of all textual witnesses provides a strong argument *for*, not *against*, the variant in question [emphasis in the original]. (Page 30* of the recent [2017] *Editio Critica Maior* for Acts.)

Well, well, well, better late than never! “The textual tradition as a whole” includes **ƒ³⁵/K^r**, of necessity. The *Text und Textwert* series¹ is now complete for the whole NT, except for John 11-21. The objective evidence it provides shows clearly, empirically, that Family 35 (**K^r**) is independent of the Byzantine bulk (Soden’s **k^x**) throughout the NT. It follows that it **cannot** be a revision of that bulk. Anyone who continues to affirm that von Soden’s **K^r** was a revision of his **K^x** is either uninformed or perverse.²

6. It remains to take up the question of the liturgical apparatus characteristic of **ƒ³⁵/K^r**. A lectionary copy would be far easier and faster to

¹ *Text und Textwert der Griechischen Handschriften des Neuen Testaments* (Ed. Kurt Aland, Berlin: Walter de Gruyter).

² To ignore clear evidence that has been called to your attention and to continue to promote a claim that you know is false, is to be perverse.